

PROJECT : TITLEImplement Client Script and UI Policy (Incident)

TASK 5: CREATE ONCELLEDIT CLIENT SCRIPT

1. Introduction

ServiceNow provides Client Scripts to control the behavior of records and forms based on different user actions. One of the Client Script types available for list-based interaction is the **onCellEdit** Client Script.

An onCellEdit Client Script runs when a user attempts to edit a field directly from a list view. In this task, an onCellEdit Client Script is created for the Incident table to control direct changes to the **State** field.

The purpose of this task is to prevent users from changing the State value directly through list editing. Instead, users are instructed to open the Incident record and make the required changes through the Incident form.

2. Problem Statement

ServiceNow Incident records can be modified either through the Incident form or directly from a list view. Direct list editing can allow users to change important fields without opening the complete Incident record.

The State field represents the current status of an Incident and is an important part of Incident management. Allowing the State to be changed directly through list editing may not provide the complete context required for the update.

To control this behavior, an onCellEdit Client Script is created. The script detects an attempt to edit the State field through the list and prevents the change.

3. Objectives

The main objectives of this task are:

- To create an onCellEdit Client Script.
- To apply the Client Script to the Incident table.
- To select the State field for list-edit control.
- To prevent direct State changes through list editing.
- To display an alert message when a list edit is attempted.

- To instruct users to open the Incident record for updating the State.
- To understand the purpose of onCellEdit Client Scripts.
- To verify that the State value remains unchanged after a blocked list edit.

4. Skills and Technologies Used

ServiceNow

ServiceNow is used to configure the Incident table and Client Script.

Incident Management

The Incident table is used for the configuration and testing of the Client Script.

Client Scripts

Client Scripts are used to control client-side behavior based on user interactions.

onCellEdit

The onCellEdit type is used to control direct field editing from a list view.

JavaScript

JavaScript is used to display the alert message and prevent the list edit.

5. Task Description

The Client Script created in this task is named:

Prevent state change via list edit

The script is configured for the Incident table.

The configuration includes:

- **Name:** Prevent state change via list edit
- **Table:** Incident
- **Type:** onCellEdit
- **Field name:** State

- **Active:** True

The purpose is to prevent users from changing the State field directly from an Incident list.

6. Activity 1: Create Client Script

6.1 Navigate to Client Scripts

Navigate to:

System UI → Client Scripts

The Client Scripts module contains the scripts configured for ServiceNow forms and list interactions.

6.2 Create a New Client Script

Click the **New** button.

A new Client Script form will open. The required details can then be entered.

7. Client Script Configuration

7.1 Name

Enter:

Prevent state change via list edit

The name clearly explains the purpose of the Client Script.

7.2 Table

Select:

Incident

This ensures that the script applies to Incident records.

7.3 Type

Select:

onCellEdit

The onCellEdit type is used when a field is edited directly from a list view.

7.4 Field Name

Select:

State

The State field is selected because the script is intended to prevent direct State changes from the list.

7.5 Active

Set:

True

This ensures that the Client Script is active and can execute when the user attempts the specified list edit.

8. Script Configuration

The following script is entered into the Script field:

```
function onCellEdit(sysIDs, table, oldValues, newValue, callback) {  
  
    alert('State cannot be updated using list editing. Please open the Incident.');  
    callback(false);  
}
```

The script displays an alert message and uses the callback to prevent the list edit.

9. Working of the Script

The script executes when the user attempts to edit the State field directly from the Incident list.

The first action performed by the script is to display an alert message.

The message informs the user:

State cannot be updated using list editing. Please open the Incident.

After displaying the message, the script executes:

```
callback(false);
```

This prevents the attempted list edit from being completed.

10. Purpose of the Alert Message

The alert message provides clear information to the user about why the State value cannot be changed from the list.

Instead of silently blocking the change, the system informs the user that the Incident record should be opened.

This helps the user understand the required method for updating the State field.

11. Submit the Client Script

After entering the configuration and script, verify the following:

- Name is **Prevent state change via list edit**.
- Table is **Incident**.
- Type is **onCellEdit**.
- Field name is **State**.
- Active is **True**.
- The required script is entered correctly.

After checking the configuration, click **Submit** to save the Client Script.

12. Testing and Verification

The Client Script can be tested from the Incident list.

First, navigate to:

Incident → All

This opens the list of Incident records.

Locate any Incident record in the list.

Try to edit the **State** field directly by double-clicking the State value.

13. Expected Test Result

When the State field is edited directly from the list, the onCellEdit Client Script should execute.

An alert message should appear informing the user that the State cannot be updated using list editing.

The State value should remain unchanged.

This confirms that the Client Script successfully blocks direct State changes from the list.

14. Form-Based Update

Although direct list editing is blocked, the State field can be updated through the Incident form.

The user can open the Incident record and change the State field from the form.

After making the required change, the user can click **Update** to save the record.

This allows State changes through the normal Incident form while controlling direct list editing.

15. Benefits

The onCellEdit Client Script provides several benefits:

- Prevents direct State changes from the Incident list.
- Encourages users to open the complete Incident record.
- Provides a clear message when a list edit is attempted.
- Helps control changes to an important Incident field.
- Maintains the State value when unauthorized list editing is attempted.
- Demonstrates client-side control of list interactions.

16. Result

The **Prevent state change via list edit** onCellEdit Client Script was successfully configured for the Incident table.

The State field was selected as the field to be controlled. When a user attempts to edit the State directly from the Incident list, the script displays an alert and prevents the change.

17. Conclusion

Task 5 demonstrates how an **onCellEdit Client Script** can be used to control direct list editing in ServiceNow.

The Client Script prevents users from changing the State field directly from the Incident list. When a user attempts the change, an alert message instructs the user to open the Incident record instead.

This task provides practical knowledge of list-based Client Script